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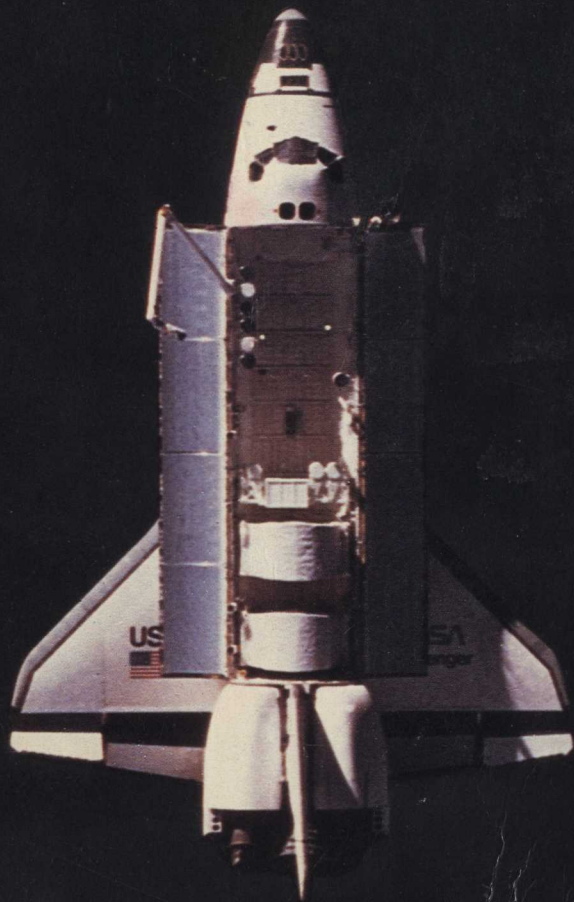
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**C**on May 5, 1961, the United States became a serious challenger in space when Astronaut Alan B. Shepard, Jr. made a 15-minute suborbital flight along the Atlantic Test Range in his Freedom 7 space capsule. With that mission, Shepard became the first American to go into space. Then, on February 20 of the following year, an American went into Earth orbit for the first time, when Astronaut John H. Glenn, Jr. did three Earth orbits before splashing down in the Atlantic. Six years and five months later, on July 20, 1969, Astronauts Neil Armstrong and Edwin Aldrin, Jr. became the first people from Earth to walk on the Moon. America had overcome a wide lead in the space technology gap in little more than a decade.

The manned lunar landings, which ended with the Apollo 17 mission in December 1972, did not conclude American manned space activity. The Skylab missions of the Seventies, which demonstrated the feasibility of manned orbiting space stations, and the space shuttle flights of the Eighties, which have shown the utility of reusable spacecraft, are but the latest chapters in the on-going story at NASA of putting and sustaining people in space.

The possibilities for manned space flight are endless. Human exploration of the nearer planets is considered practical. The means to develop the technology to do so is in place now. The only limitations are those which we have not yet learned to overcome: The ordering of priorities and allocation of resources.

## MANNED SPACE FLIGHT

### *Americans On the Moon*

Astronaut James B. Irwin salutes the U.S. flag beside the Lunar Module and the lunar rover during the Apollo 15 mission on the Moon. Irwin, with Astronaut David R. Scott, logged more than 18 hours of travel from the Lunar Module Falcon's base on the Marsh of Decay to the foothills of the Apennine Mountains.







**Webb and Dryden** NASA Administrator James E. Webb (left) and deputy administrator Dr. Hugh L. Dryden listen to a presentation given to President Lyndon B. Johnson at NASA headquarters in February 1965. Webb, who served as administrator from February 1961 to October 7, 1968, helped America's space program go from short-distance suborbital flights to the threshold of the Moon.

#### **America's First Astronauts**

Only six months after NASA was formally established on October 1, 1958, the first seven astronauts were announced for Project Mercury. Shown in the front row, left to right, are Walter M. Schirra, Jr., Donald K. Slayton, John H. Glenn, Jr., and Scott Carpenter. Shown left to right in the back row are Alan B. Shepard, Jr., Virgil I. "Gus" Grissom and L. Gordon Cooper.



#### **Commitment to a Manned Moon Landing**

"I believe this nation should commit itself to achieving the goal, before this decade is out, of landing a man on the Moon and returning him safely to Earth." That goal, described by President John F. Kennedy in a historic speech before a joint session of Congress on May 25, 1961, was realized at 10:56 PM EDT on July 20, 1969, when Astronaut Neil A. Armstrong became the first human being to set foot on the Moon. Behind the President are (left) Vice-President Lyndon B. Johnson, and (right) Speaker of the House of Representatives Sam T. Rayburn.



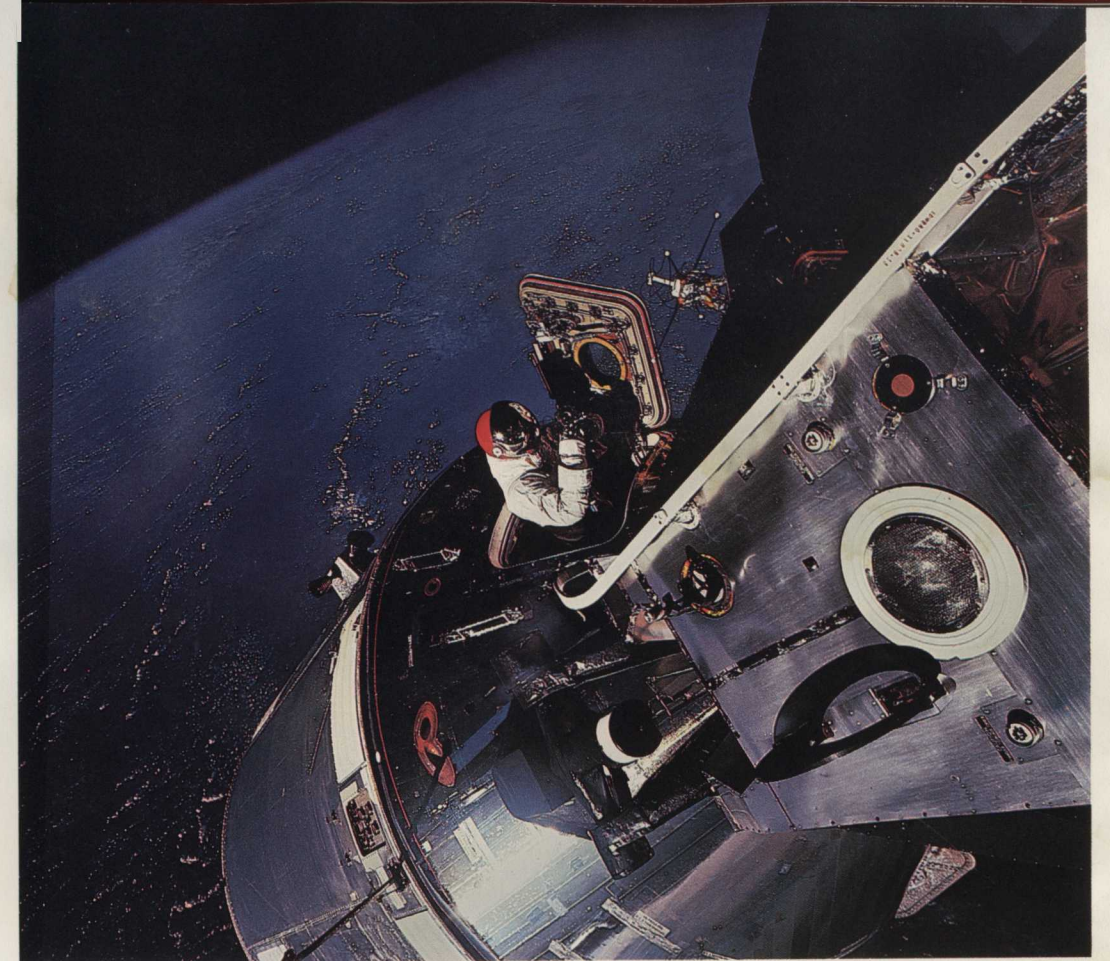


**Earthrise** Parts of Africa, Europe, North and South America can be seen through the blue haze of Earth rising over the Moon's surface in this striking photo taken from the Apollo 8 manned spacecraft in lunar orbit. Apollo 8 was the first manned Saturn V flight. It left the Kennedy Space Center at Cape Canaveral on December 21, 1968, via a Saturn V launch vehicle with Astronauts Frank Borman, James A. Lovell, Jr., and William A. Anders; and accomplished ten lunar orbits.

**Ill-Fated Astronauts** Astronauts (left to right) Virgil Grissom, Edward White and Roger Chaffee were the only fatalities in all of America's space missions. On January 27, 1967, the three died in an Apollo spacecraft fire during pre-launch activities at Cape Canaveral. The astronauts were preparing for an Apollo/Saturn 204 Earth orbital mission scheduled for February of that year.

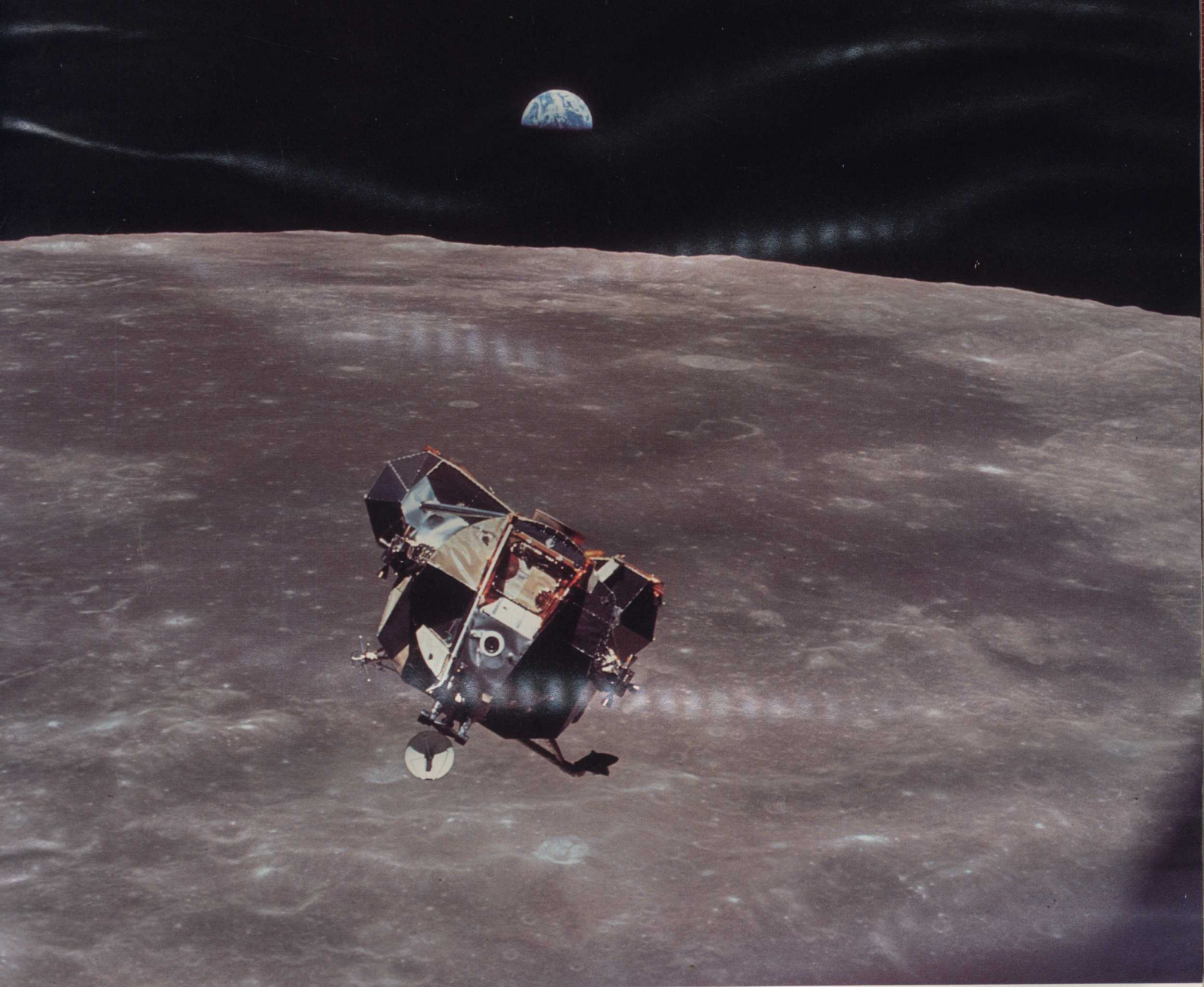


**Orbital View** While in Earth orbit, Astronaut David R. Scott stands in the hatch of the Apollo 9 command module and gets set to photograph Astronaut Russell L. Schweickart, who took this dramatic scene during an extra-vehicular activity. The command module was launched on March 3, 1969, by a Saturn V rocket from the Kennedy Space Center at Cape Canaveral. Scott, Schweickart and Astronaut James McDivitt were in Earth orbit for over 241 hours during which time they tested all of the manned lunar mission equipment.



**Saturn S-IVB Stage** High over the Gulf of California in Earth orbit, Apollo 7 astronauts Walter M. Schirra, Donn F. Eisele and Walter Cunningham saw this view of the Saturn S-IVB stage with which they rendezvoused to within 70 feet. The S-IVB Saturn stage came from the same Saturn 1B rocket which sent the Apollo 7 astronauts into space from the Kennedy Space Center at Cape Canaveral on October 11, 1968, for docking and maneuvering exercises. The white disk on the left side of the vehicle's spherical surface is used as a docking target.





***Ascent from the Moon*** Orbiting the Moon in the Apollo 11 command module, Astronaut Michael Collins took this striking photograph of the lunar lander rising from the Moon's surface with Astronauts Edwin Aldrin and Neil Armstrong. In this picture, the lunar landing vehicle is about to rendezvous and dock with the command module which will take

all three astronauts back to Earth for the successful conclusion of America's first manned lunar landing. A half-Earth can be seen rising beyond the lunar horizon.



**A Hero's Welcome** Apollo 11 Astronauts Edwin Aldrin, Michael Collins and Neil Armstrong stand in an open car as throngs of New Yorkers welcome them in an August 13, 1969 parade, which was estimated to be the largest in the city's history.



**A Presidential Welcome** President Richard M. Nixon greets astronauts (left to right) Neil A. Armstrong, Michael Collins and Edwin E. Aldrin, Jr., on July 24, 1969, four days after Armstrong and Aldrin walked on the Moon, and just after they splashed down in the Pacific 900 miles southwest of Hawaii. The Apollo 11 Astronauts are shown within their quarantine trailer aboard the USS Hornet.





**Reflection on the Moon** Apollo 12 Astronaut Charles Conrad, who took this picture, is reflected in Astronaut Alan Bean's EVA visor as the two astronauts explore the lunar surface. Bean and Conrad touched down on the Moon on November 19, 1969, on America's second manned lunar landing mission. Astronaut Richard Gordon was the Command Module Pilot.



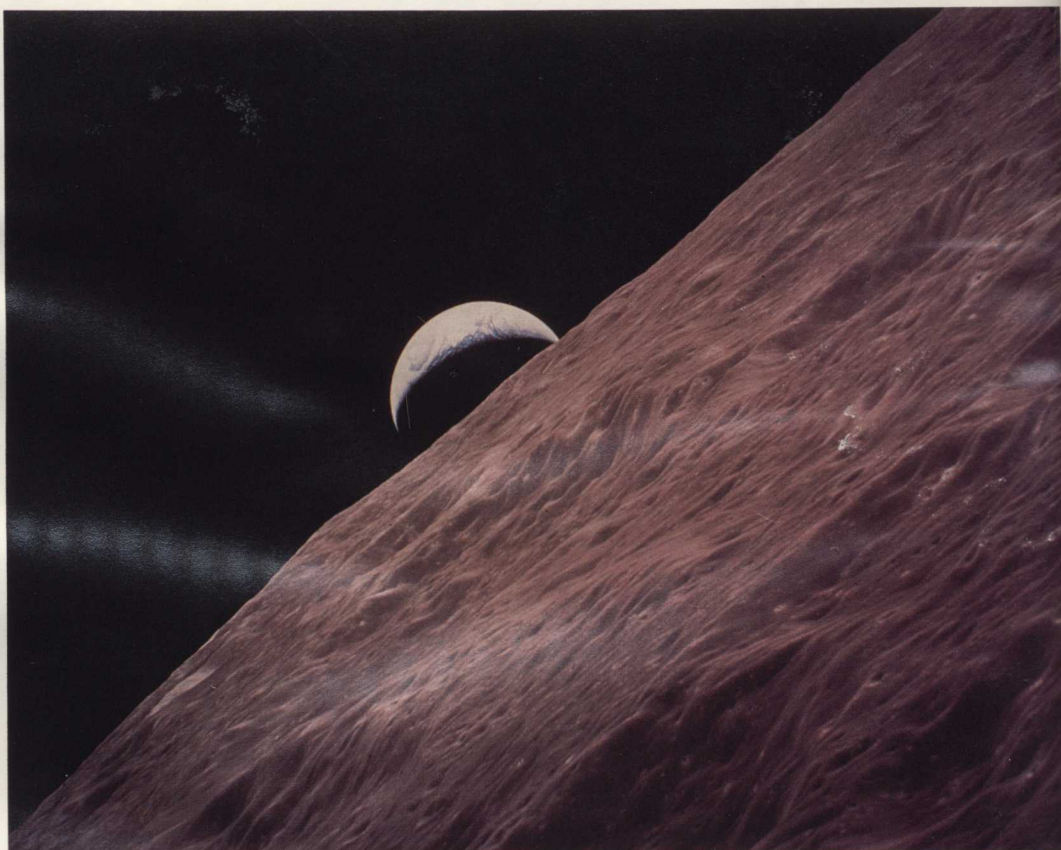
**Sunbathed Moon** The Sun's golden disk illuminates the Moon's surface in this photograph of the Apollo 14 lunar module, which appears to be sheathed in gold. An S-band transmission antenna, and the American flag indicate the presence on the lunar surface of Astronauts Alan B. Shepard, Jr., and Edgar D. Mitchell. Shepard, Mitchell and Astronaut Stuart Roosa, who piloted the command module in lunar orbit, left the Kennedy Space Center at Cape Canaveral atop a Saturn V rocket on America's third manned Moon landing mission, January 13, 1971.



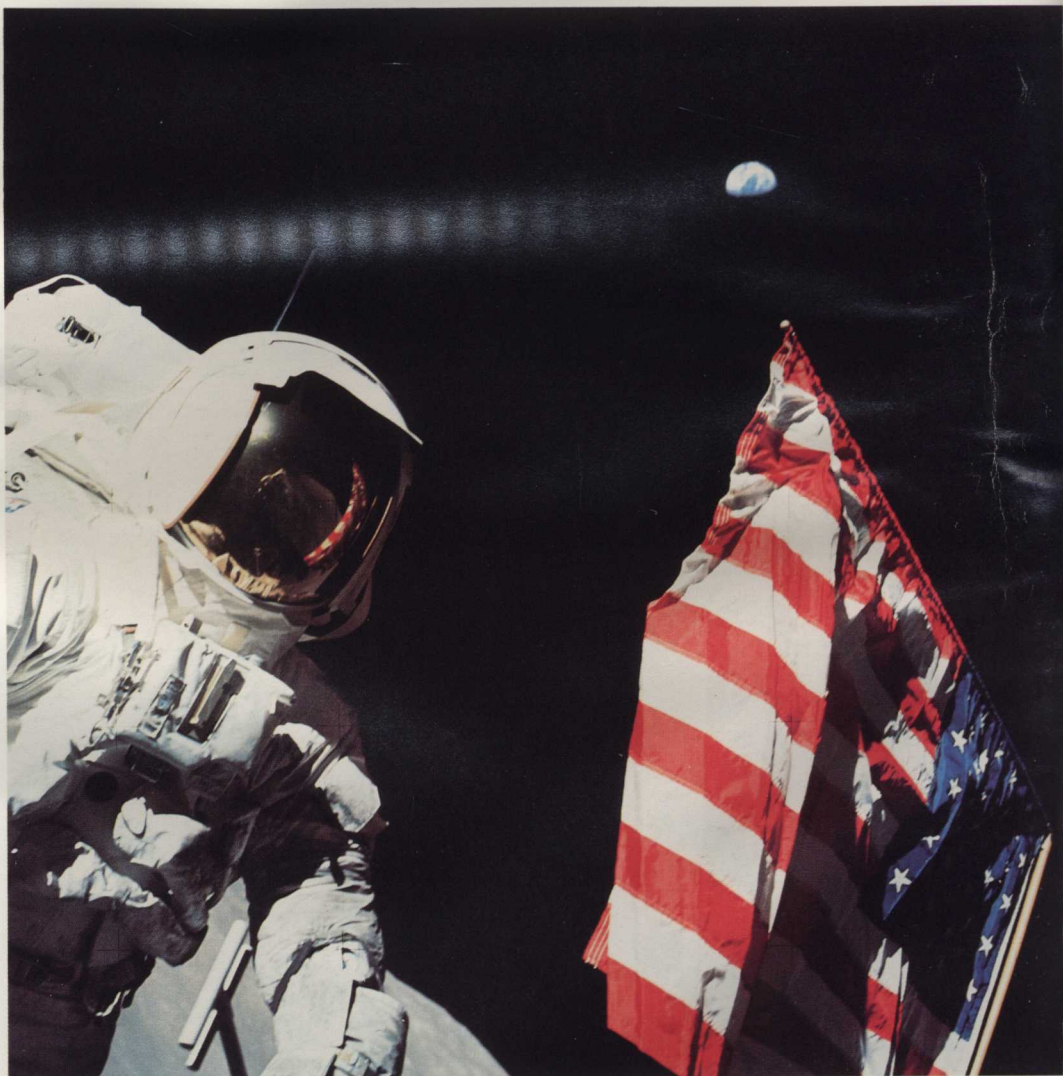


***Earthrise Over The Moon***

Apollo 17 astronauts photographed the Earth coming up over the lunar horizon in this spectacular photo taken from the Apollo Command Module.



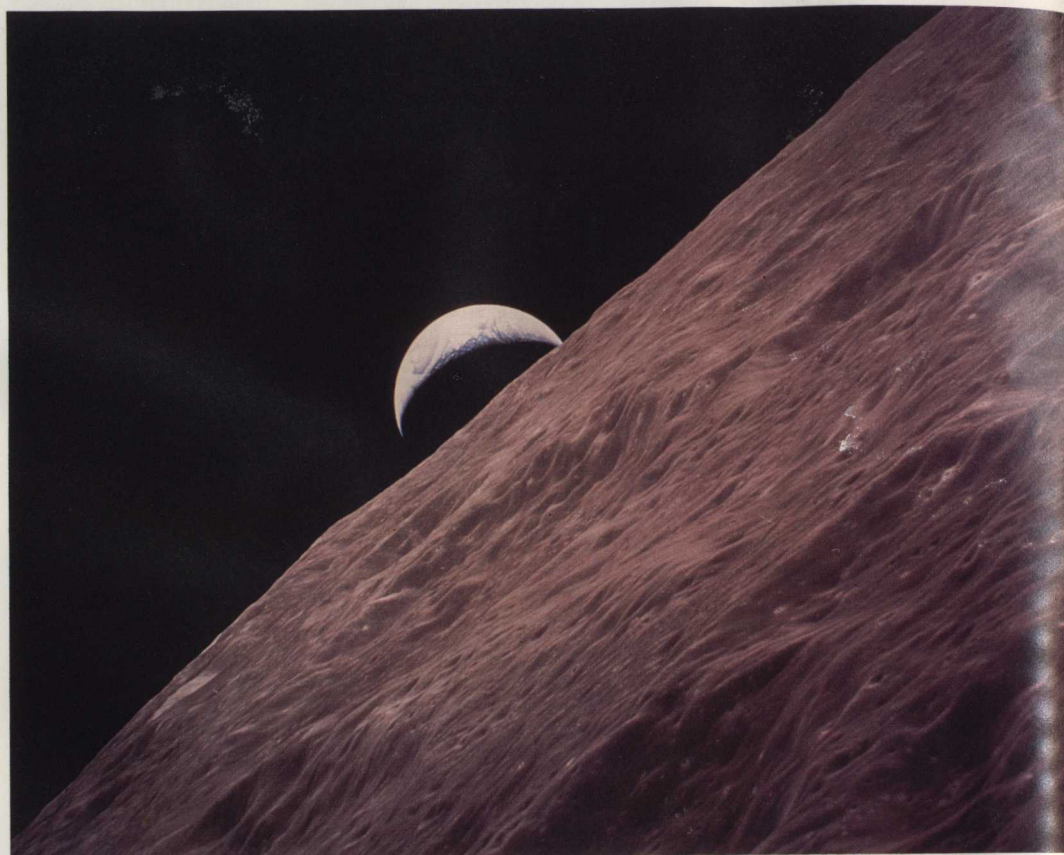
***Astronaut and the Flag*** Apollo 17 Astronaut Eugene Cernan took this photograph of Astronaut Harrison Schmitt beside the American flag on the Moon's surface. Apollo 17, which was America's last manned lunar landing, left the Kennedy Space Center on December 7, 1972 and returned to Earth on December 19th. In this picture, the Earth appears as a blue pearl in space just beyond the edge of the flag.



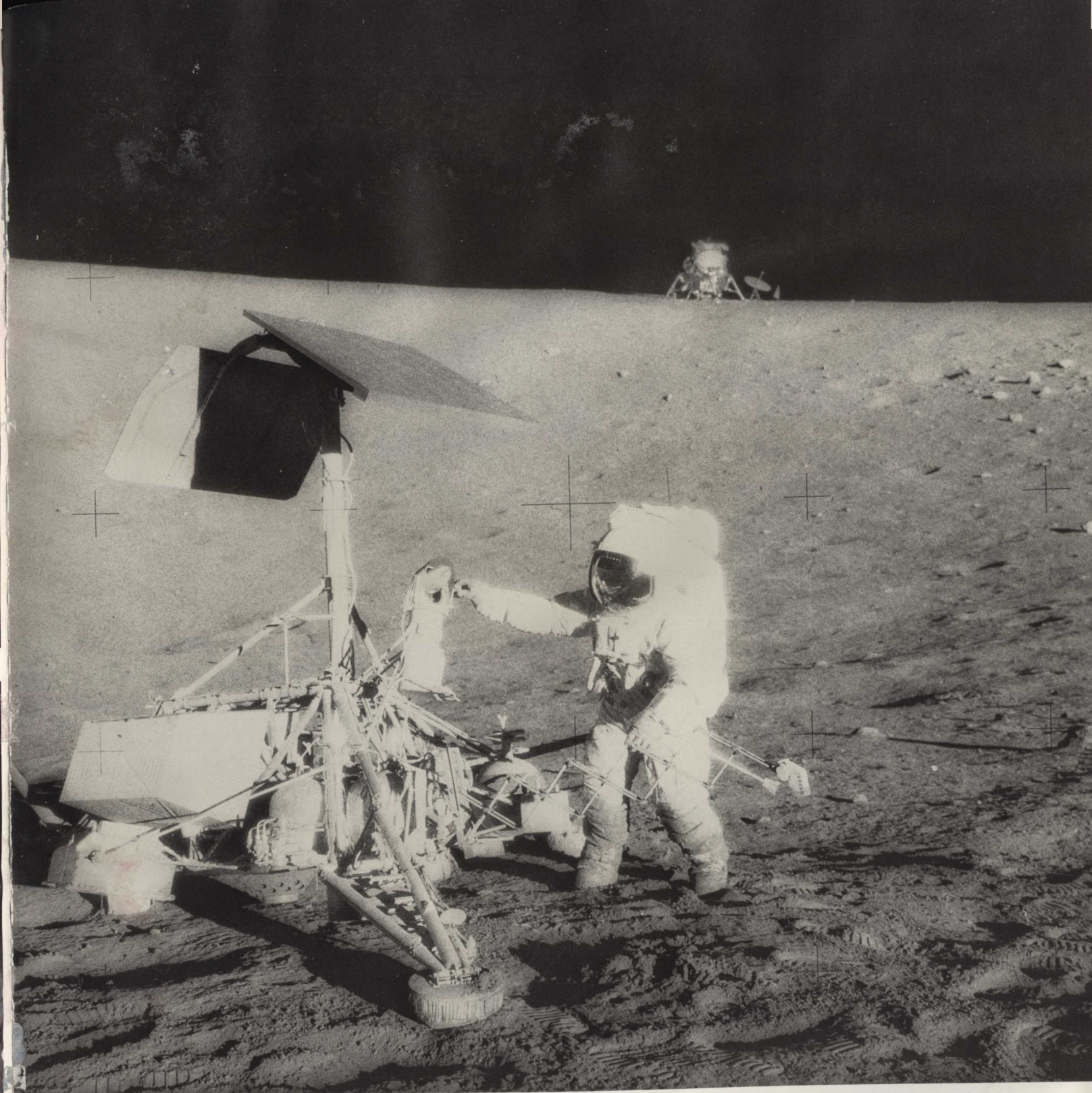


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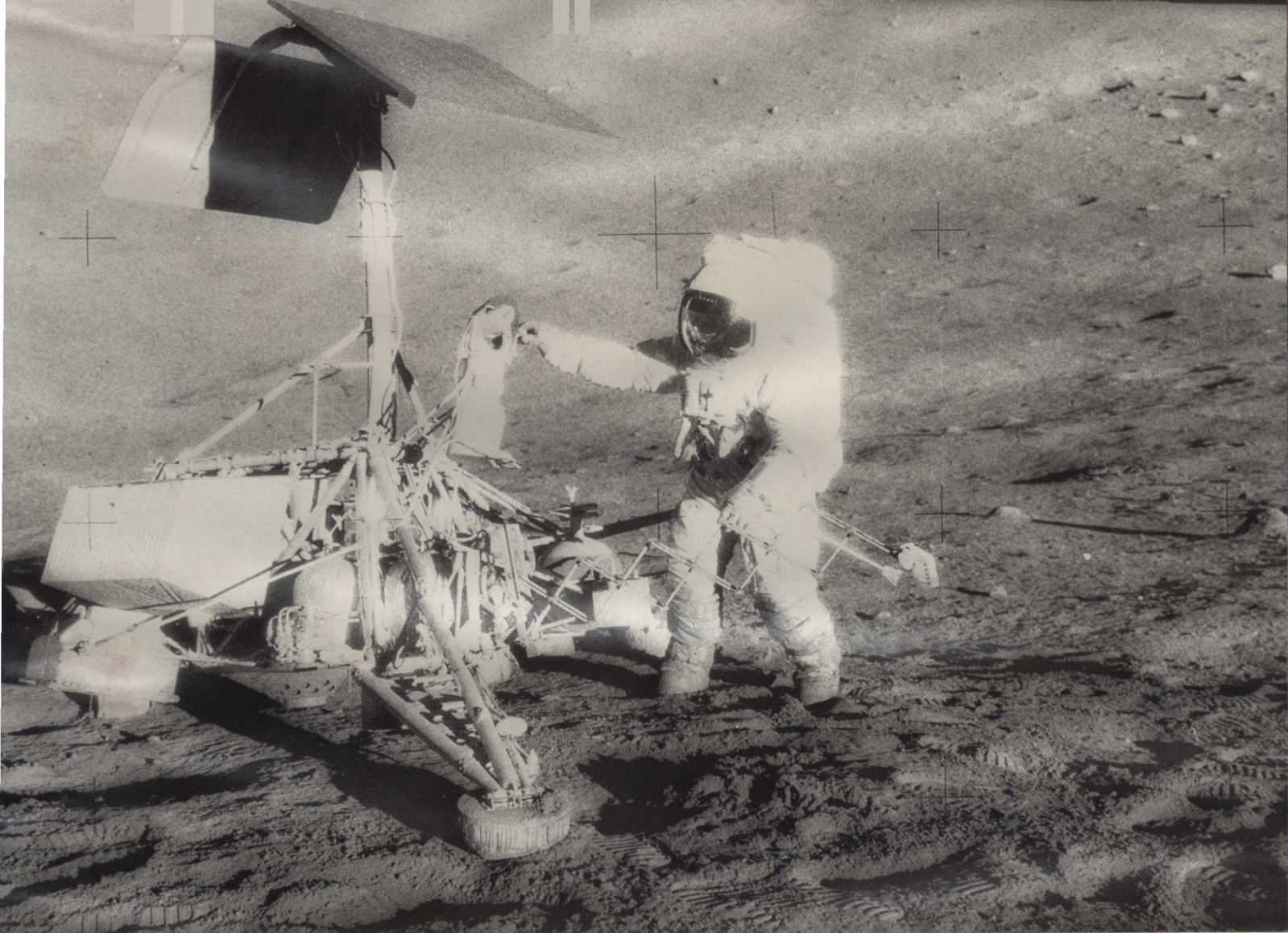
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**Apollo Meets Surveyor** Apollo 12 Astronaut Charles Conrad examines the television camera on the Surveyor 3 spacecraft, which had been on the Moon since April 1967. The unmanned Surveyor 3 once transmitted over 6,000 pictures of the lunar landscape to Earth. The photo of Conrad and Surveyor 3 was taken by Astronaut Alan Bean who, along with Conrad, made

America's second manned lunar landing on November 19, 1969. The Apollo 12 lunar landing vehicle is visible in the background.





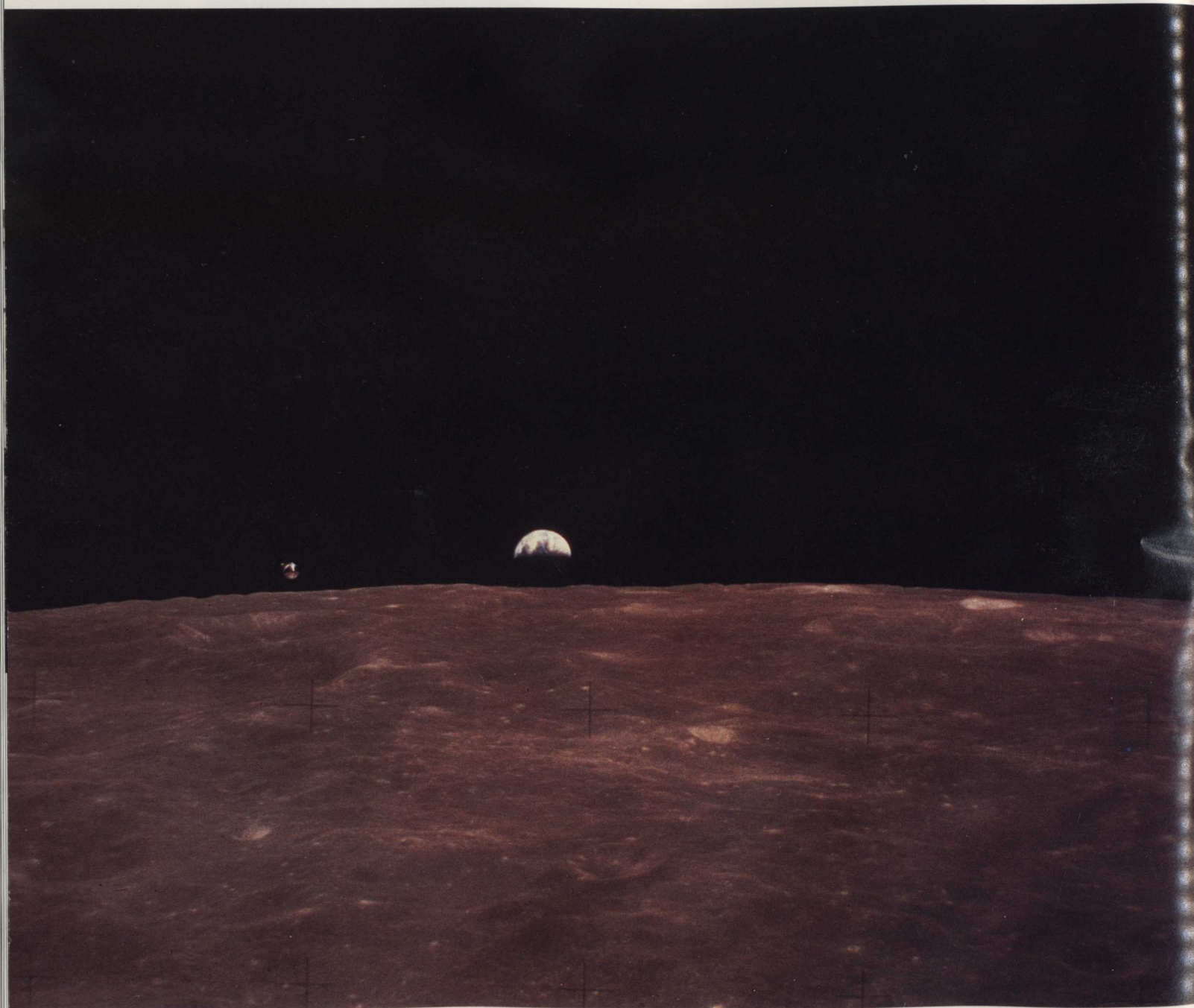
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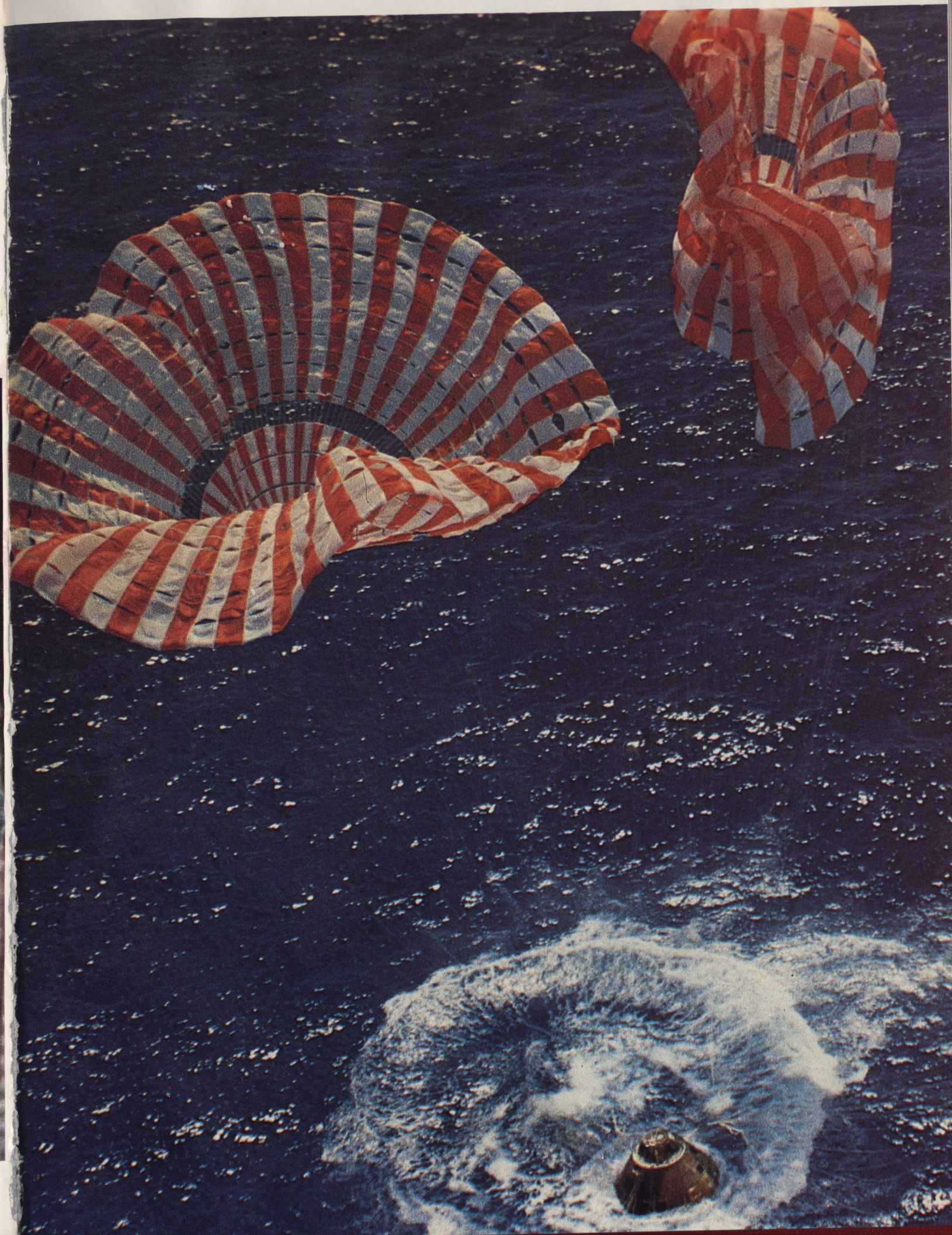


**Probing for a Lunar Module**

The Earth rises, and just above the edge of the lunar horizon is Apollo 16 Astronaut Thomas K. Mattingly II's command module awaiting rendezvous and link-up with Astronauts John W. Young and Charles M. Duke, who took this picture from their lunar landing craft just after leaving the Moon's surface. Astronauts Young and Duke just spent over 71 hours on the Moon's surface.



**Splashdown** Red and white parachutes billow above blue Pacific waters at the moment of splashdown for Apollo 15 astronauts David R. Scott, James B. Irwin and Alfred M. Worden. In this photo, taken by photographer Victor Rhoder from a Navy helicopter, the wake around the Apollo spacecraft is still sharply discernable. The splashdown, which successfully concluded America's fourth manned lunar landing attempt, occurred more than 300 miles north of Hawaii on August 7, 1971.



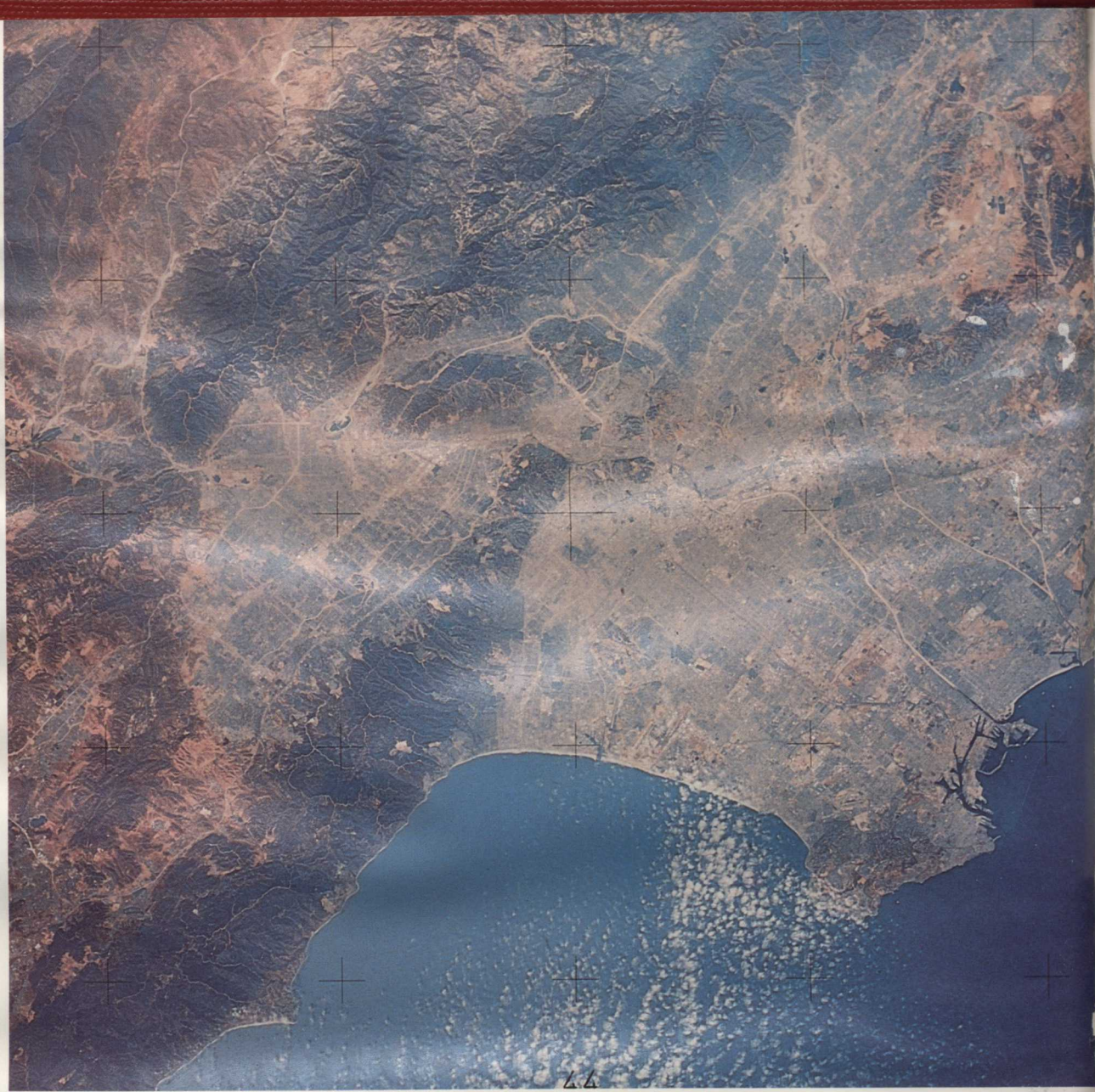




**Apollo Meets Soyuz** Once rival competitors in the race for the first manned Moon landing, the United States and the Soviet Union participated in one joint space project, the Apollo-Soyuz Test Project. This photo, taken from the Apollo spacecraft, shows the Soviet Soyuz vehicle in Earth orbit just prior to the rendezvous and docking of the two vehicles on July 17, 1975. Linked in Earth orbit for two days, Astronauts Thomas P. Stafford, Vance D. Brand, and Donald K. Slayton visited Soviet Cosmonauts Valeriy N. Kubasov and Aleksey A. Leonov. The American astronauts began the historic mission from the

Kennedy Space Center at Cape Canaveral aboard a Saturn IB rocket on July 15 and splashed down in the Pacific on July 24. The Soviet cosmonauts left Baykonur in the Soviet Union on July 15 using an A-2 launch vehicle and returned to a Kazakhstan recovery area on July 21.

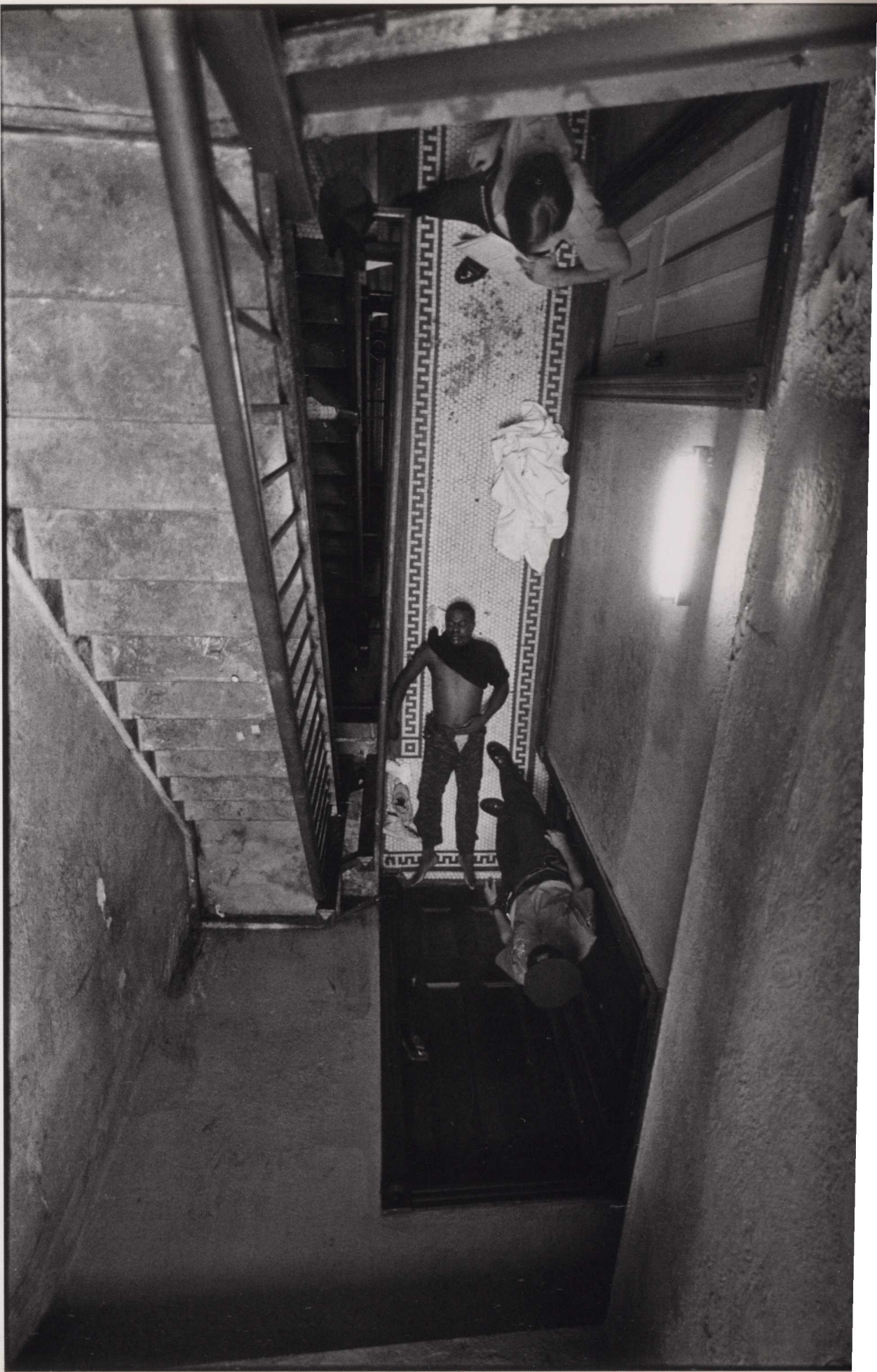












Death from overdose, Harlem, 1978

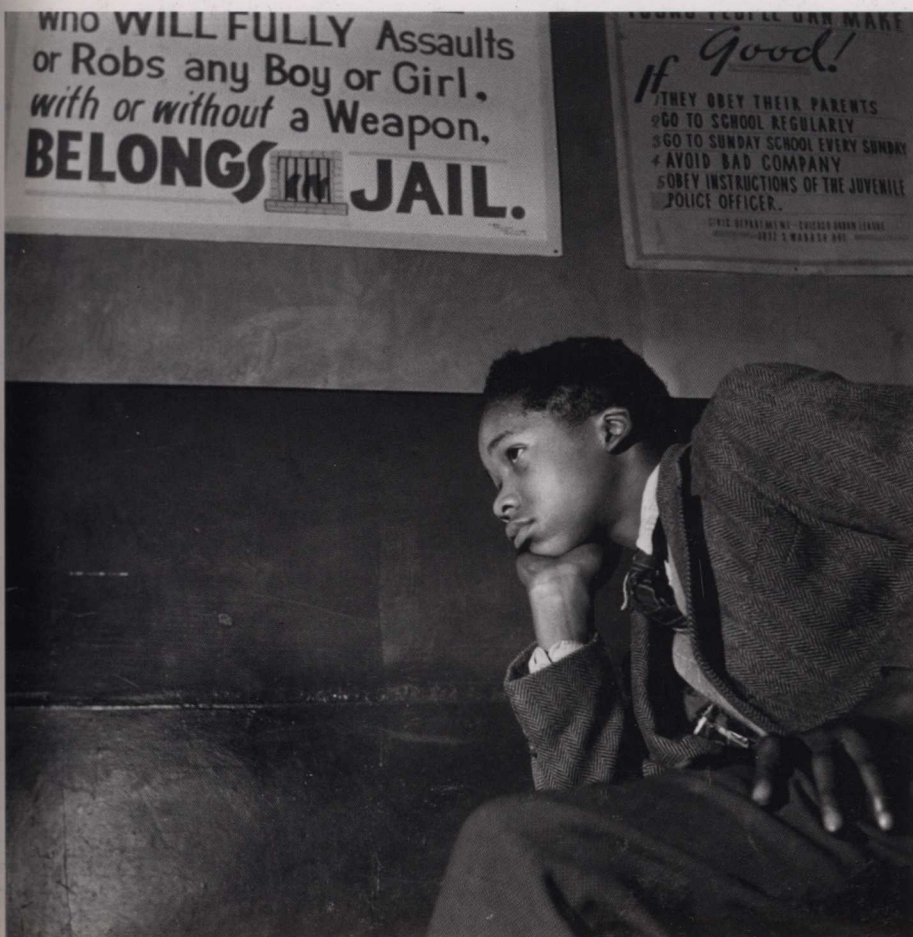




Husband and wife with bills, 1948



A deserted mother wondering what she can do with a newborn baby she cannot support, 1947



Court for juveniles at Wabash Avenue police station presided over by Sylvester 'Two Gun Pete', 1947



Dancing at the 45th Street bar that catered to slaughterhouse workers, 1947





Durango Colony, Durango, Mexico, 1994





Making 'it'